Ticket 6

TCK06-Leaver

Summary

Category	Account management
Request	Jade Ali (HR) has left the company
Action	Disable the account, remove the department group, record a note, move the account to the Disabled OU
Tools	Active Directory Users and Computers (ADUC), PowerShell
Outcome	Resolved. The account is disabled and sign-in is refused

Problem

Jade Ali (HR) has left the company. An account left active after someone leaves is a security risk. It still holds a valid password and every permission the person had.

Background: disable, don't delete. The standard response is to **disable** the account, not delete it:

• **Deleting destroys the account's identity** (its SID). Permissions, audit trails, and any access tied to it can't be restored by simply recreating a user with the same name.

• **A disabled account can be re-enabled** if the person is rehired or the wrong account was disabled.

• **History stays intact** for audits. Deletion happens later, under the company's retention policy.

Validate the request first. A leaver request should come from HR or the person's manager, with an effective date. Disabling the wrong account locks out someone who is still working. In a full offboarding, the AD steps are one part of a larger list that also covers mailbox, files, devices, and other systems.

Environment

Item	Detail
Domain	acme.local
Account	jali (Jade Ali), `Acme / Users / HR`
Department group	`GRP-HR`
Destination OU	`Acme / Disabled`
Tools	ADUC, PowerShell

What each step does

Step	Purpose
Disable	Blocks sign-in
Remove department groups	If the account is ever re-enabled by mistake, it doesn't come back with access
Description note	Records when and why, so anyone reviewing the account understands its state
Move to the Disabled OU	Separates leavers from active staff, so reviews and clean-ups are simple

Troubleshooting Steps

#	Action	Result
1	In ADUC: `Acme / Users / HR` → right-click **Jade Ali** → **Disable Account**.	AD confirms: Object Jade Ali has been disabled.
2	Open the user's **Properties** → **Member Of** tab, select `GRP-HR`, click **Remove**. `Domain Users` stays, because it is the account's primary group and can't be removed.	Department group removed.
3	**General** tab: add a short note in the **Description** field, visible to anyone browsing the OU.	Description saved.
4	Right-click the user → **Move...** and select `Acme / Disabled` as the destination.	Account moved to the Disabled OU.
5	Verify in AD with `Get-ADUser jali -Properties Description | Select-Object Name,Enabled,Description,DistinguishedName`.	`Enabled` is `False`, the description is saved, and the distinguished name ends in `OU=Disabled,OU=Acme`, which confirms the move landed in the right OU.
6	Client: attempt to sign in as the leaver (`jali`).	Windows refuses: "Your account has been disabled. Please see your system administrator."

This message separates a disabled account from the other sign-in failures:

Message	Cause
"Your account has been disabled"	Account disabled (this ticket)
"The referenced account is currently locked out"	Locked out (Ticket 02)
"The user name or password is incorrect"	Wrong password

Root Cause

The person left the company, so the account has to be taken out of use without destroying its identity (see Problem).

Fix

Disable the account, remove `GRP-HR`, record a description note, and move the account to `Acme / Disabled` (Troubleshooting Steps, steps 1 to 4).

PowerShell equivalent

```
# Disable
Disable-ADAccount -Identity jali

# Remove the department group
Remove-ADGroupMember -Identity GRP-HR -Members jali -Confirm:$false

# Record the change
Set-ADUser jali -Description "Disabled 2026-10-06 - leaver ticket"

# Move to the Disabled OU
Get-ADUser jali | Move-ADObject -TargetPath "OU=Disabled,OU=Acme,DC=acme,DC=local"
```

Verification

In Active Directory:

```
Get-ADUser jali -Properties Description |
  Select-Object Name,Enabled,Description,DistinguishedName
```

Enabled is False, the description is saved, and the distinguished name ends in OU=Disabled,OU=Acme, which confirms the move landed in the right OU.

From the client: the sign-in attempt as jali is refused with the message specific to disabled accounts: "Your account has been disabled. Please see your system administrator."

Lessons Learned

• **Disabling blocks new sign-ins only.** Sessions already open, and Kerberos tickets already issued, can keep working until they expire (about 10 hours by default). For an urgent exit, the disable is paired with ending active sessions.

• **Write dates unambiguously.** 6/10/2026 reads as 10 June in US format and 6 October elsewhere. An ISO date such as 2026-10-06 can't be misread, and it's worth adding a ticket number to the note.

• **Rehire:** re-enable the account, move it back to its department OU, and re-add groups with approval.

• **Don't delete.** Removal happens later, under the retention policy.

If something goes wrong

Symptom	Cause
Move into the Disabled OU fails with Access denied	Helpdesk delegation is missing on the destination OU. Moving needs rights at both ends.
The user can still sign in on a laptop	Offline cached credentials. A disabled account is enforced once the PC reaches the domain controller.
The user is still working in an open session	Disabling doesn't end existing sessions. Sign them out.
GRP-HR can't be removed or the Remove button is greyed	The wrong group is selected. Domain Users is the primary group and can't be removed.

Command reference

```
# Disable
Disable-ADAccount -Identity jali

# Remove the department group
Remove-ADGroupMember -Identity GRP-HR -Members jali -Confirm:$false

# Record the change
Set-ADUser jali -Description "Disabled 2026-10-06 - leaver ticket"

# Move to the Disabled OU
Get-ADUser jali | Move-ADObject -TargetPath "OU=Disabled,OU=Acme,DC=acme,DC=local"

# Verify account state and group membership
Get-ADUser jali -Properties Description | Select-Object Name,Enabled,Description,DistinguishedName
Get-ADPrincipalGroupMembership jali | Select-Object Name

# List every disabled account
Search-ADAccount -AccountDisabled | Select-Object Name,SamAccountName

# Rehire
Enable-ADAccount -Identity jali
```

Screenshots

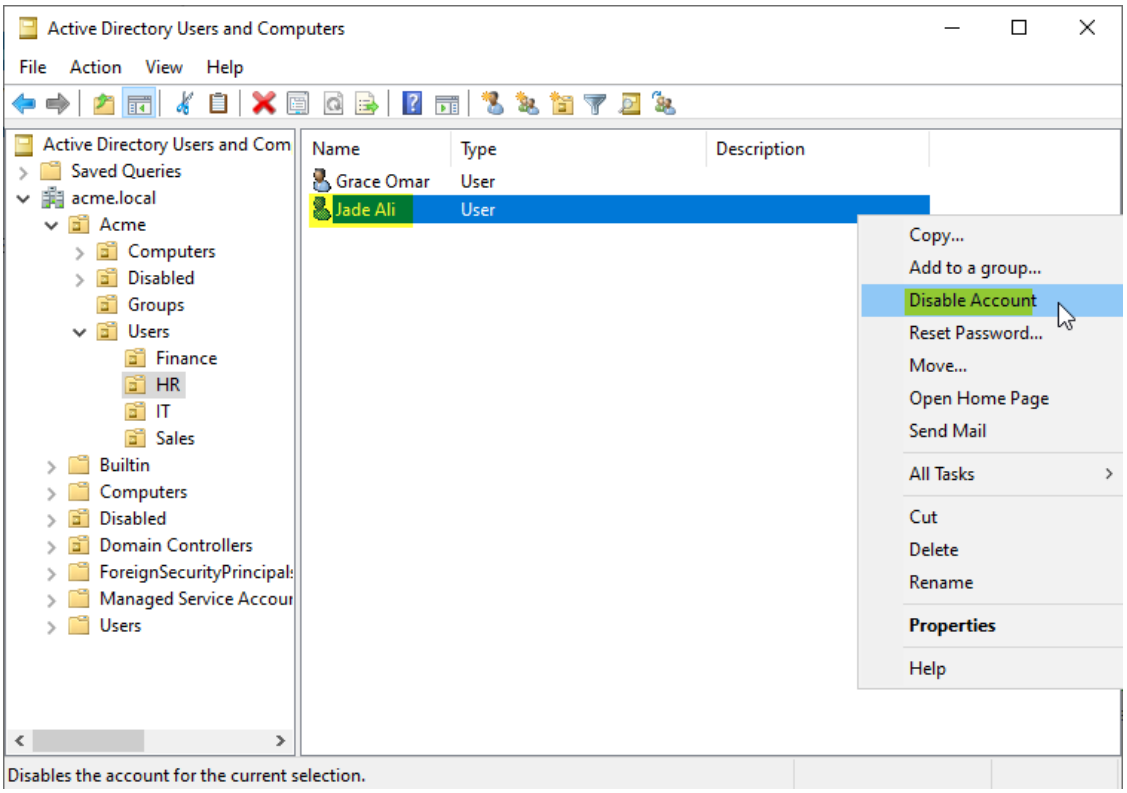


Figure 1. Context menu with Disable Account highlighted

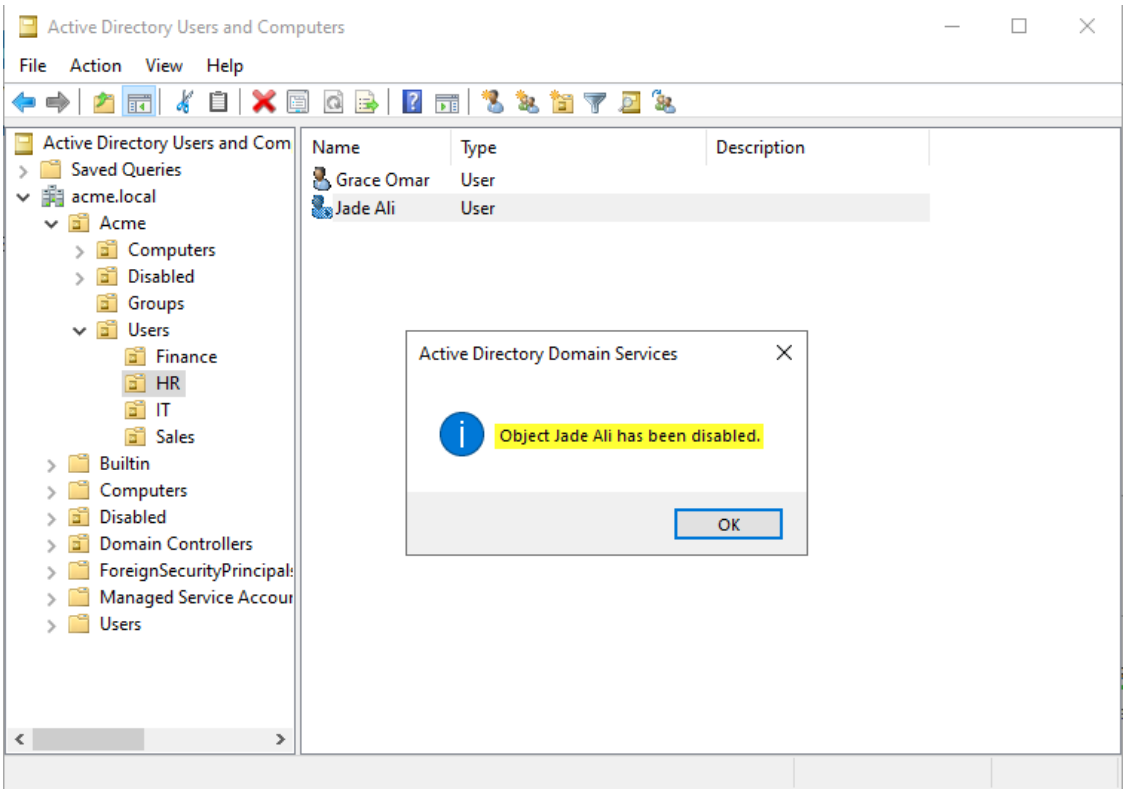


Figure 2. Confirmation: Object Jade Ali has been disabled

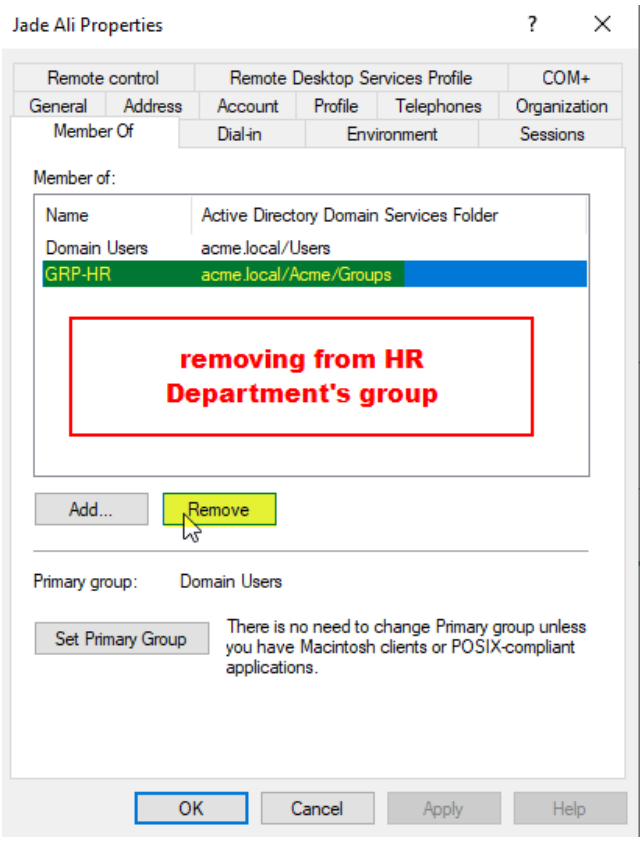


Figure 3. Member Of tab with GRP-HR selected and Remove highlighted

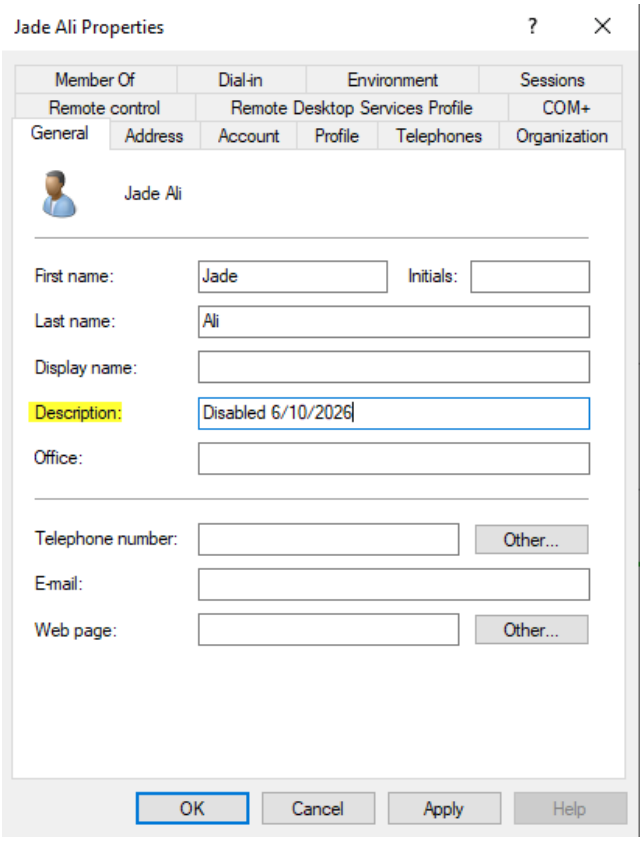


Figure 4. General tab with the Description note

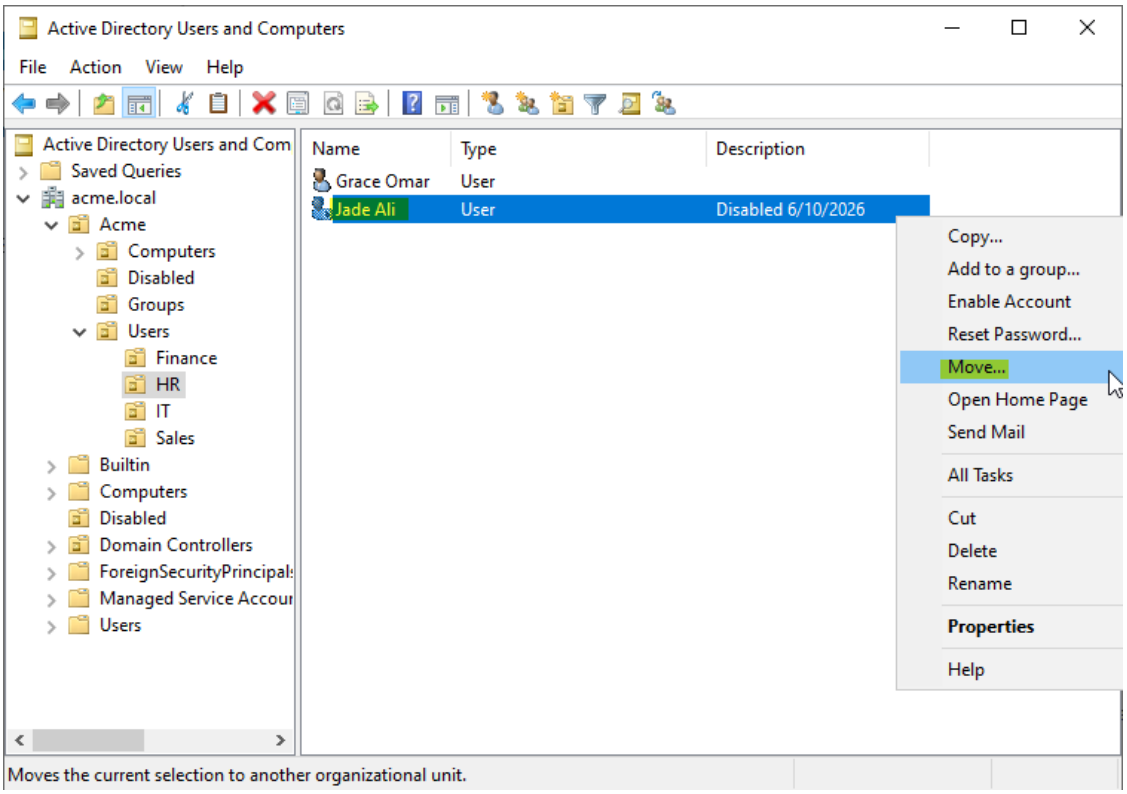


Figure 5. Context menu with Move highlighted

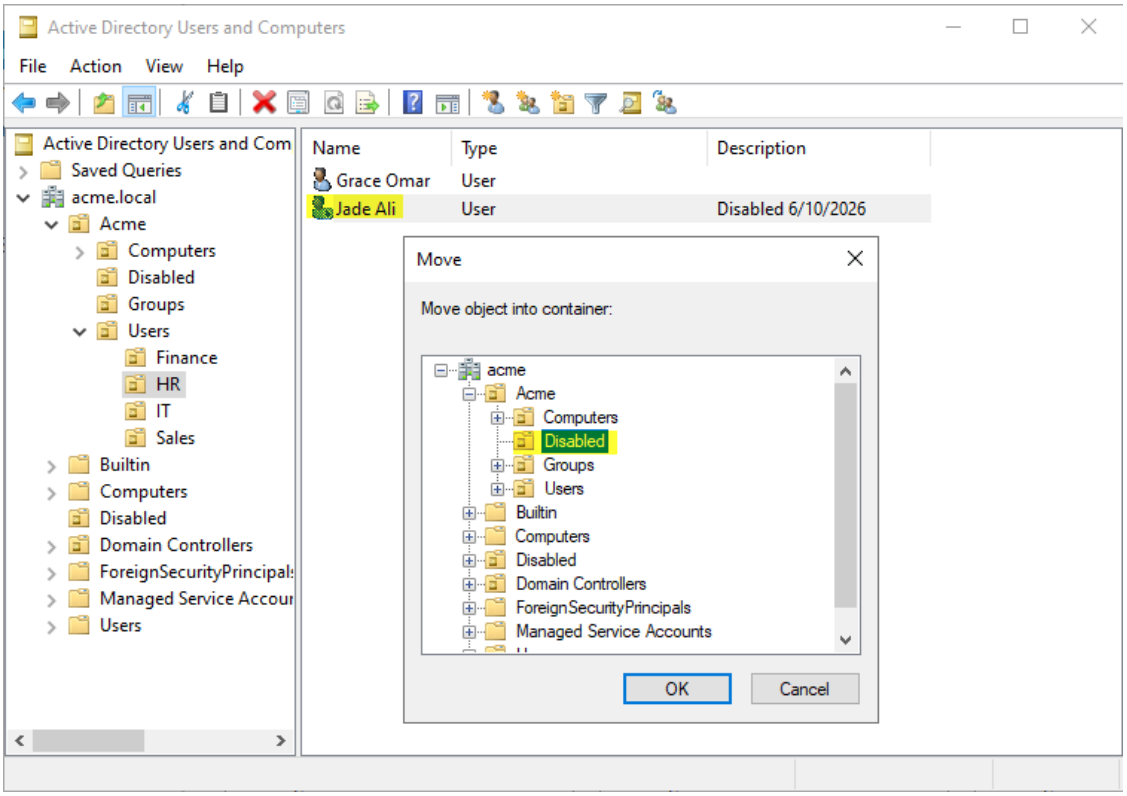


Figure 6. Move dialog with Acme / Disabled selected

```
Windows PowerShell
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Install the latest PowerShell for new features and improvements! https://aka.ms/PSWindows

PS C:\Users\Administrator> Get-ADUser jali -Properties Description | Select-Object Name,Enabled,Description,DistinguishedName

Name      Enabled Description        DistinguishedName
----      ------- -----------        -----------------
Jade Ali    False Disabled 6/10/2026 CN=Jade Ali,OU=Disabled,OU=Acme,DC=acme,DC=local
```

Figure 7. Get-ADUser output showing Enabled False and the Disabled OU

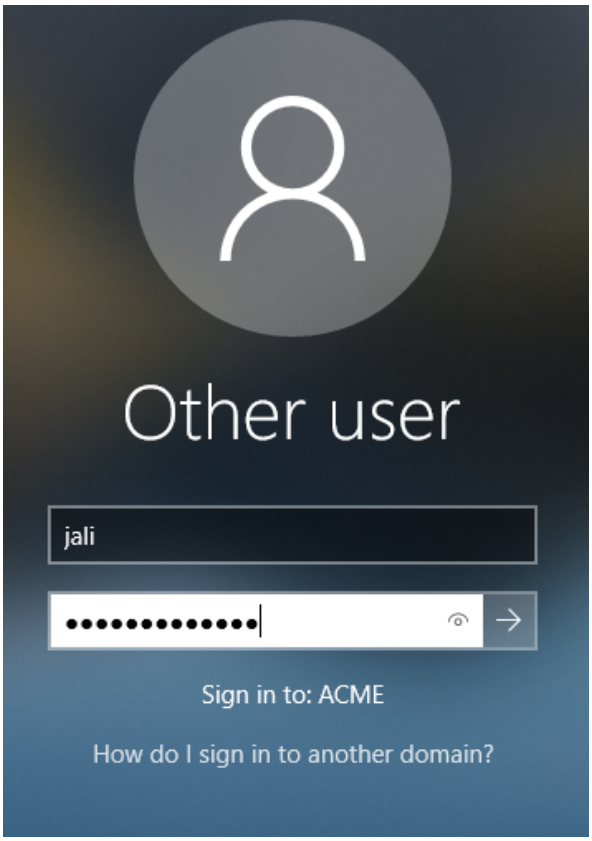


Figure 8. Sign-in screen for jali

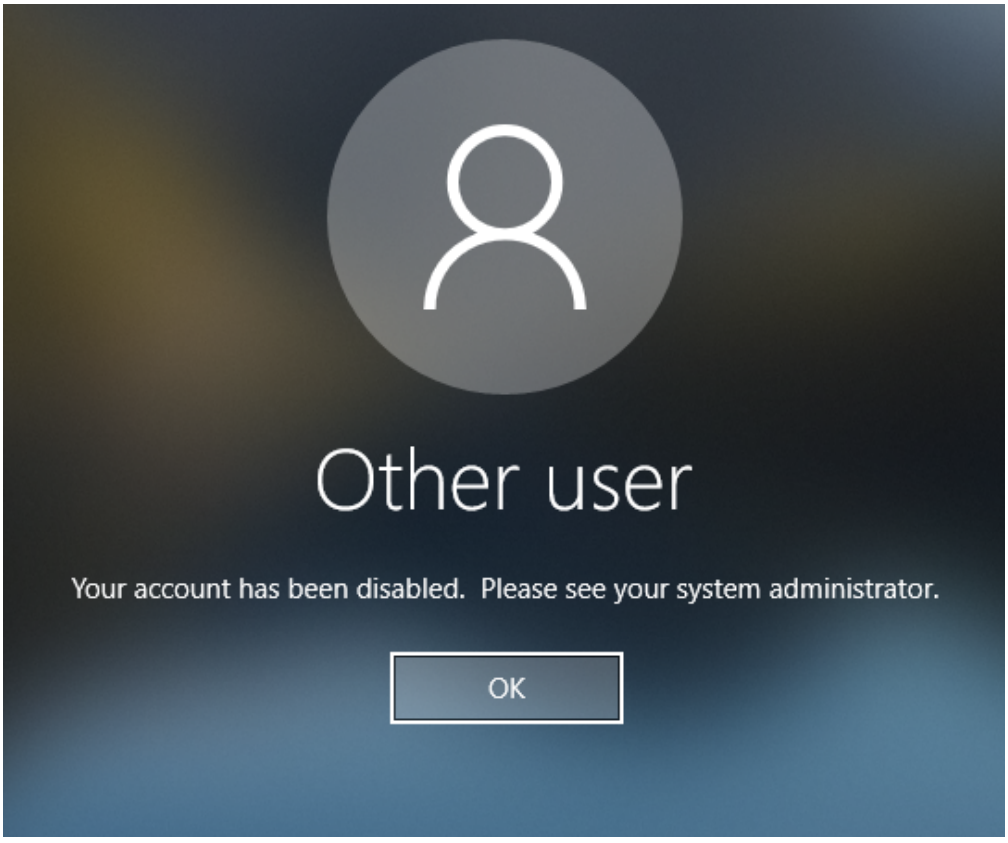


Figure 9. Error: Your account has been disabled. Please see your system administrator.